MCP

Title:
Nora Wants a Baby

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NOTES

This play was born out of an even shorter skit which was part of a compilation in the play Baby Mama Drama, which was originally performed in the fall of 2006 at Studio Academy Charter Arts High School in Rochester, Minnesota.

The original cast members were: Matt Meriwethers, Mike Baker, Jessica Meyers, Mercedes Madline, Matthew Chase, Andy Hoye, Ericka Street and Candy Marra.

While this is intended as a comedy duet with one person playing Nora and the other person playing the other characters, this can certainly be done as one person or as a short play with multiple characters.

A big thanks to Ehryn Barthelme and Planned Parenthood of Rochester who worked with my students and helped book shows at local schools in Rochester. Also, to Eric Holsen who had to bravely take over directing the show while I made an unscheduled trip to South Korea to do some parenting of my own.

A big thanks to my family as always.

CAST OF CHARACTERS

Nora	SHE is not the famous explorer named Dora.
Galoshes	HE is Dora's pet monkey and that's the way he wants it to stay.
Baby	HE / SHE starts the whole obsession.
Map	HE / SHE knows where to go... always.
Teacher	HE / SHE is a teacher. Enough said.
Wiper	HE has been stalking Nora.
Denny	HE is a bull.
Blue Arrow	OPTIONAL

NOTE: In the event that this is played by two people, it will work best when one person plays Nora and the other person plays the rest of the characters.

SETTING: The stage is bare, with an exception to several blocks that may be used in various places as determined by the director.

AT RISE: Spanish music begins to play. Nora enters with her friend, Galoshes.

NORA

Hola, I'm Nora. And this is my friend, Galoshes.

GALOSHES

Hola.

NORA

Please don't confuse us with the other show on TV that stars a Spanish girl and her pet monkey.

GALOSHES

We're not them.

NORA

At all.

GALOSHES

No resemblance.

NORA

(very serious) I'm Nora.

GALOSHES

(extremely serious) And I'm Galoshes.

NORA

Today we're going to going to talk about the word embarazada. Can you say embarazada? (They look at audience.) Good. Do you know what embarazada means? (They pause perhaps a little too long.) That's right. It means pregnant. Can you say pregnant?

GALOSHES

Are you pregnant, Nora?

NORA

No, but remember when we saw that baby earlier and it was so cute?

GALOSHES

(Not sure where this is going, and not liking it, but agreeing anyway.) Maybe?

NORA

I sure wish I could have the baby. I wish I was embarazada. I would love it and kiss it and call it George.

GALOSHES

That's a nice name.

NORA

I know I saw the baby around here earlier. (To audience) Do you see it?

(There is a long pause as GALOSHES and NORA look at the audience. Behind them a baby crawls across the floor. Another actor enters dressed in all blue, carrying a large blue arrow and "clicks" on the baby. To avoid confusion as a comedy duet, you can cut the arrow bit.)

BLUE ARROW

Click!

BABY

Hola!

NORA

There it is. There's the baby.

(Baby crawls off stage. Blue Arrow follows.)

GALOSHES

Yep, there's the baby.

NORA

Oh, but look, it crawled away. Where did it go?

(Galoshes shrugs his shoulders.)

NORA

I think we need the map. Where's the map?

MAP

(Enters) I'm the map, I'm the map, I'm the map, I'm the map. I'm the map, I'm the map, I'm the

map, I'm the map. Map!

NORA

Okay, Map, we're trying to get a baby. Can you tell us how to get to it?

MAP

Uh, what do you want a baby for?

NORA

I want to love it and kiss it and call it George.

MAP

Yeah, you're only four years old. You've got a long ways to go.

NORA

Then show me the way.

MAP

Right. So first you need to go through education, cross the bridge of marriage, take the career path and climb the hill of financial stability. You got that?

NORA

I'm not sure. What is it?

MAP

Education, marriage, career and money.

NORA

I'm not sure I like that way. What if I want a career first and then get married later?

MAP

You asked me to show you the way. I did. I'm a map.

NORA

Right. Education, marriage, career and money. Education, marriage, career and money. I think I've got it. (Out to the audience) Can you say it with me? Education, marriage, career and money. Education, marriage, career and money.

MAP

You only need to say it once.

NORA

I learn through repetition, okay? This coming from someone who said "I'm a map" about a billion times?

MAP

I'm going to leave now. Good luck on that whole baby thing.

NORA

Thanks, Map. Well, we better get started. Right, Galoshes?

GALOSHES

Sure.

NORA

(To audience) Where's the first place we have to go?

GALOSHES

Okay, hold on a second. Are you talking to me or to someone else?

NORA

I'm talking to everyone out there that's watching me on television.

GALOSHES

And are they talking back?

NORA

Yes, can't you hear them?

GALOSHES

(Listens, nods head as if agreeing.) No.

NORA

Never mind that now. We have to get to Education. (Pause) Where are we going? (She begins to march around the stage with Galoshes following.)

NORA / GALOSHES

Ed-u-ca-tion.

NORA

Where are we going?

NORA / GALOSHES

Ed-u-ca-tion.

NORA

Where are we going?

NORA / GALOSHES

Ed-u-ca-tion!

(They take a few steps, but are halted by a teacher.)

TEACHER

And just where do you think you are going?

NORA

The map told me to go through education, Mrs. Teacher.

TEACHER

Through education? You mean to say you can just waltz on through education without doing the work?

NORA

What work is that?

TEACHER

You must do your homework before passing through education.

NORA

What is my homework?

TEACHER

(Hands her some papers.) Do these questions and the study guide and answer the odd questions on the last page. When you are done with that, you may pass through education. I'll be waiting.

(The teacher crosses arms and waits. Nora walks away.)

NORA

Wow, there are a lot of homework problems to do. I'll never get my baby now. (To audience) Will you help me?

GALOSHES

Maybe you should do your own work.

NORA

Ha, ha. You're silly, Galoshes. We need lots of people to help. Do you want a baby or not?

GALOSHES

Not real…

NORA

So, here is the first question. What is five plus four?

(Wiper enters)

WIPER

This is perfect. If Nora wants to have a baby now, then I need to make a move.

NORA

Oh, oh. Look everyone, it's Wiper. What's Wiper doing?

WIPER

Hey, there. You sure are looking hot today.

NORA

I am?

GALOSHES

Oh, no, Nora. Wiper is flirting with you.

NORA

He is?

GALOSHES

(To audience) C'mon, everybody. We need to tell Wiper to stop flirting. Wiper, no flirting. Wiper, no flirting. Wiper, no flirting.

NORA

Wait a second! No! Leave him alone!

WIPER

Oh, man! (Wiper Exits)

NORA

What were you doing, Galoshes? I could have been embarazada.

GALOSHES

Have you forgotten already, Nora! Education, Marriage, Career and Money. And besides, Wiper is kind of a stalker. Why is he always following you around?

NORA

Stalking is just a creepy way of saying "I like you just a little too much."

GALOSHES

I think creepy is the important word there. Best leave that option alone.

NORA

You're right, Galoshes. What was I thinking?

GALOSHES

Obviously not about education.

NORA

Hey, the teacher isn't here. Let's get out of here and go to the next step.

GALOSHES

I don't think that's a good idea. You need an education. No child should be left behind.

NORA

Let's face facts, Galoshes. You don't need an education to get a baby.

GALOSHES

Good point. At least you should go to the next step. Where did the map say you should go?

NORA

The next step was the bridge of marriage. (To Audience) Do you see where marriage is?

(They pause and stare at the audience. The Blue Arrow enters along with Denny the Bull. Denny stands on a couple of blocks that have been pushed together. The Arrow runs around a bit and then points at Denny. Again, the Blue Arrow can be optional.)

BLUE ARROW

Click!

NORA

There it is. There's the Bridge of Marriage. And there's Denny the Bull. Hi, Denny!

DENNY

Hola, Nora. What great adventure are you on today?

NORA

I'm trying to get embarazada, but I have to cross the bridge of marriage first.

DENNY

I'm thinking this is a puzzle you don't have to solve yet.

NORA

I don't need any bull from you, Denny.

DENNY

But I am a bu....

NORA

Let's cut to the chase. Will you marry me, Denny?

DENNY

I'm scared.

NORA

It's a simple question, Denny. Yes or no? (Pause) Why is Denny running away?

GALOSHES

You're getting rather aggressive, Nora. Sometimes you have take things slow.

NORA

But I want a baby and I want it now!

GALOSHES

Temper tantrums aren't going to help. Do you need a nap?

NORA

Forget this marriage idea. There are plenty of independent women out there that have babies.

GALOSHES

Have I mentioned that you're only four years old?

NORA

Career and money is next right? Those go pretty much hand in hand. So what's a career that can make me a lot of money and embarazada at the same time? (Stares at audience for a long time)

GALOSHES

The only profession I can think of would be the world's oldest profession.

NORA

What's that? (To audience) Do you know what the world's oldest profession is?

GALOSHES

(To audience) Please don't answer that.

NORA

Don't tell my people what to do.

WIPER

(Wiper Enters) Hey, mamacita, I can be your first customer.

NORA

Wiper!

GALOSHES

Wiper, no soliciting! Wiper, no soliciting!

WIPER

Awww, man!

NORA

No, Wiper, don't go away. I've lost him again. Aren't there any other boys out there?

GALOSHES

I'm afraid they're all gone, Nora.

NORA

But, if they're all gone, all that's left is you.

GALOSHES

(Short Pause) Let's see if the map is still around.

END